CORRECTION NOTICE

The central result of this manuscript is WITHDRAWN.

Issued 2026-09-06 by the author (v5 of this record). This notice was added to the archived record; the manuscript itself is unaltered. This record has not been peer reviewed.

What is wrong

The force exponent reported here as alpha = 3.92 +/- 0.16 is an artifact of the fitting procedure, not a property of the data. The fit was unweighted least squares in linear space applied to a steeply falling profile, which places 95.8 percent of its objective on the single point at the shortest retained separation. Re-fitting the same data with nothing discarded, changing only the error model, gives 2.82 (relative-error weighting) or 2.89 (log-space regression). Across fifteen combinations of standard estimator and fit window the exponent spans 2.53 to 3.92, and the value published here is the largest of them.

What the data show instead, and how firmly

The retraction is certain. The replacement is not. On the open 24-site chain the same data give alpha = 2.6 +/- 0.2, where the interval is the spread of a plateau in the local logarithmic slope over six consecutive separations, not a statistical error (the bootstrap error on the published fit to the same data is 0.63); the plateau value was reproduced at 2.5921 by a separately written implementation run on the same recorded state (SIM-2026-073). This is a single geometry at a single size. On a 24-site periodic ring, analysed with chord distance as pre-registered, two probes that are both energy-density-like (Delta = 1) give 1.83 and 2.37 against a CFT two-point value of 2 (SIM-2026-074): one size, not converged, disagreeing with each other by 29 percent, and not attributable to a single operator channel. **No corrected exponent is established. The exchange channel is an open question.** Treat 2.6 +/- 0.2 as the provisional open-chain value, not as a result.

Also withdrawn or voided

Claim in versions 1 to 4	Was	Now	Why
alpha = 3.92 +/- 0.16 (24 sites) and alpha = 3.97 +/- 0.15 (16 sites, exact) from stress-tensor exchange	headline result and its first corroboration	withdrawn	the same estimator artifact: both move in lockstep under it (3.92 to 2.56, 3.97 to 2.75 on dropping the contact point), because they share one observable, one fit window and one fitting routine
scalar exchange (alpha = 2) excluded	stated as excluded at about 12 sigma	withdrawn	the 12 sigma used the covariance error 0.16; at the bootstrap error 0.63 computed before release the exclusion is about 2.2 sigma, and under any window starting at separation 3 the point estimate itself falls to about 2.56
alpha = 4 is universal; alpha = 4.00 at Ising, tricritical Ising and Potts	confirmed at three classes	withdrawn; the operator towers at all three classes stand	the exponent was measured only at Ising and inherited by the other two; the towers are spectra, not forces

Claim in versions 1 to 4	Was	Now	Why
third independent evaluation alpha = 4.07 (chi = 3 MERA), and with it the statement that this was the first holographic force measurement from an optimized tensor network state	supporting evidence and a priority claim	both withdrawn	the profile changes sign inside its own fit window and cannot be a fixed-sign power law; the priority claim rests on that evaluation alone and was never gated against prior work
the discriminating test: stress tensor (Z_j Z_j+1) versus spin primary (X_j)	registered killer test	void	at the critical point these are one operator, related by exact Kramers-Wannier self-duality. Measured on the periodic ring: identical expectation values to 1e-15 and identical force profiles to 1e-13 at 14 sites, 2.4e-9 at 24 sites (SIM-2026-074). Open boundaries break the duality, which is why the open-chain run of this test (SIM-2026-073) showed a spurious difference between the two arms. The test compared the energy density to itself. Neither label was correct: Z_j Z_j+1 is the energy density, not the stress tensor; X_j is its dual, not the spin primary
transport time T = (pi/2) l_AdS to 1.2 percent as a geometric prediction	confirmed	measurement stands (T = 2.239 at N = 16); geometric reading not established	l_AdS cancels in the cited derivation, which also gives pi rather than the pi/2 the manuscript compares against; the chi = 3 estimate of l_AdS gives a 57 percent miss; the transport driver never applies a MERA

The true spin primary Z_j was never in the design, and the direct replacement test is blocked: Z_j is odd under the Z2 symmetry, so the energy-difference observable used throughout this work subtracts across symmetry sectors and is undefined for it. A replacement test using two Z2-even probes has been pre-registered (PREREGISTRATION-T.md, committed before its driver) and run; its result is deliberately not part of this correction and will appear in a later version.

Not previously reported

The published fit has a reduced chi-squared of 6.008 on 9 degrees of freedom, and a bootstrap standard deviation of 0.63 rather than the quoted 0.16. Both were computed before release and omitted.

What is unaffected

Of the claims in this record: the two-phase optimization method, the chi = 3 criticality threshold, the exact-diagonalization gates, the measured OPE coefficient C_sigma-sigma-epsilon = 0.50 +/- 0.03 against the exact 1/2, and the conformal towers at all three classes. Not part of this record, mentioned only because they are sometimes read together with it: the later C_TTT stress-tensor self-coupling measurements (SIM-2026-067/068/069, dated after this record) and the matched off-critical ring control (SIM-2026-074) are unaffected by this correction and make no claim about the force exponent.

How the error was found and what this record contains

The error was found by the author's own internal adversarial audit, not by a reviewer; the journal submission it was found after is closed, and no review of this work has taken place. Files in this record: the full re-analysis (SIM-2026-072.json, driver, figure), the pre-registered chain test (SIM-2026-073.json) and ring test (SIM-2026-074.json) with both pre-registrations as committed before the runs, the runnable drivers with their shared module and the negative test suite for their validation gates, and the error register (ERRATA.md).

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